The match failed, as we expected, but when we add a title to Sally, it succeeds. Note that the title named group only gets the last of the two values, for our purposes here, that's not a big deal, but it might cause an issue in other cases.

Let's try this on our list:

tut_regexp/validate_attendees.rb

```
NAMES = [
  "Mr Jones and Sally",
  "Mr Bond and Ms Moneypenny",
  "Samson and Delilah",
  "Dr Jekyll and himself",
  "Ms Hinky Smith and Ms Jones",
  "Dr Wood and Mrs Wood",
  "Thelma and Louise"
]

NAMES.each do |line|
  re = %r{ ^(?>
             (?:(?<title>Mrs | Mr | Ms | Dr )\s)? (.*?) \s and \s
           )
             (?(<title>)\g<title>\s) (.+)
         }x
  if line.match?(re)
    puts("VALID:   #{line}")
  else
    puts("INVALID: #{line}")
  end
end
```

produces:

```
INVALID: Mr Jones and Sally
VALID:   Mr Bond and Ms Moneypenny
VALID:   Samson and Delilah
INVALID: Dr Jekyll and himself
VALID:   Ms Hinky Smith and Ms Jones
VALID:   Dr Wood and Mrs Wood
VALID:   Thelma and Louise
```

Alternatives in Conditions

As they say in informercials, "But Wait! There's More!" Conditional subpatterns can also have an *else* clause.

```
(?(group_id) true-pattern | fail-pattern )
```

If the identified group was previously matched, the true pattern is applied. If it failed, the fail pattern is applied.

Here's a regular expression that deals with red or blue balls or buckets. The deal is that the colors of the ball and bucket must be different.

```
  re = %r{(?:(red)|blue) ball and (?(1)blue|red) bucket}

re.match?("red ball and blue bucket")  # => true
re.match?("blue ball and red bucket")  # => true
re.match?("blue ball and blue bucket") # => false
```